

miss better candidates for your innovation journey because these candidates are modest about their achievements.

I have seen in many cases people jump the gun and celebrate their innovation win too early. In other cases, the proportion of their celebration does not even match the outcome. It can be detrimental to your innovation programme in the long run.

Candidate's modest nature often puts them behind the queue. So, next time you find a candidate being modest about their achievements, chances are they are a good fit for the innovation role.

17. They are experimenters and action takers

As a corollary to point 4 and 6 above, innovative people are avid experimenters and have a strong bias towards taking action. You will find them constantly experimenting and testing out various assumptions. And when they see a positive outcome or find a way through that experimentation, they take action.

It often needs tenacity, perseverance, and patience. Many see patience as a roadblock in a world where everything is moving fast or appears to be moving fast. But not the innovators.

So, in your hiring process, see how you can check these qualities. Particularly, see how you can make them show the experimenter in them. It will be interesting as well as supportive of the process of selection.

18. Look for diversity of thinking, experience, and skills

When we talk about diversity, we usually think of gender balance or demographics. However, for innovation, we also need diversity of thinking, experience, and skills.

Diversity of thinking comes from the fact that you have learned to think differently. You do not just follow what others are saying. Your opinions are based on what you see around you, and you can think independently on your feet. And therefore, in most cases, this thinking is different from others.

The other part is about perspective. Because of the diversity of experience, you are able to see the same issue from different angles.

Futures literacy has become a need of the hour. You cannot just innovate or develop anything in silos anymore. You not only need to understand what is going on around you at any given point time, you need to be aware of trends and fads in your industry, and the economy.

Talking about the experience, if you have a candidate who has experience in the same industry for a very long time, the chances are that they haven't seen enough. Different perspectives from other industries, whether they are better or maybe worse, are important. Regardless, these candidates won't be aware of it. A candidate from different industry experiences or different types of roles has gathered so much variety that it helps them think innovatively. So, look for a variety of experiences.

And of course, for the skills, you need someone who is not just a specialist in one thing but in many. It is important because innovation is often about finding new ways to do something, new combinations, and original combinations. Apparently, that is only possible when someone has a diverse set of skills; so go for it.

19. Entrepreneurs should be welcomed

Now, this one is interesting. I want to emphasize this point because I have often seen companies being skeptical of hiring entrepreneurs. They think that entrepreneurs may leave early or will be more distracted thinking about their next venture. Well, this is a very negative outlook on entrepreneurs.

First of all, entrepreneurs are and can be more loyal to you than an employee can. They understand it

because they have had their employees, and they exactly know what you expect of them.

But more importantly, entrepreneurship teaches you so many different skills and techniques. They have gathered so much expertise through their entrepreneurial venture. So, once you have an entrepreneur in your innovation journey, you have multiple employees packed together in that one person. Therefore, if you get a chance to hire an entrepreneur for your innovation plans, jump on it; do not lose that opportunity. Without question, it is a very good bargain.

20. They are future-literate

Futures literacy has become a need of the hour. You cannot just innovate or develop anything in silos anymore. You not only need to understand what is going on around you at any given point time, you need to be aware of trends and fads in your industry, neighbouring industries, and the economy. But you also have to be aware of what is coming and what might be coming in time to come.

That means people need to be aware of future scenarios. So, futures literacy is becoming more and more important. The complexity and volatility of the markets and economies force people to stay two steps ahead at any time. Being future-literate will help you do that, which is why you must look for this trait.

